Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
2022 Capital Budget and 2023-2031 Long Range Capital Forecast
Held Electronically at 7:00 p.m. on November 29, 2021

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
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Present:	Chair - Councillor	L. Bower
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Bower called the meeting to order at 7:01 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Budget Chair's Opening Comments

Councillor Bower, Budget Chair, provided opening comments, thanked staff for preparing the 2022 Capital Budget and 2023-2031 Long Range Capital Forecast, and reviewed highlights of the proposed budget.

4. Finance Department Budget Presentation

Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance / Treasurer, delivered a presentation on the 2022 Capital Budget and 2023-2031 Long Range Capital Forecast.

D. Valentim provided an overview of the Town's capital budget and 2023-2031 long range capital forecast and discussed capital budget funding, the Financial Sustainability Plan, and capital reserve allocations. D. Valentim reviewed the 2022 Draft Capital Budget, including capital project funding, budgeted expenditures and pressures, Canada Community-Building Fund details, and concluded the presentation with a review of multi-year/pre-budget approval projects.

Committee Members sought clarification regarding allocation of 2021 operating budget surplus and changes in the capital funding program. Committee Members asked questions regarding the Town's purchasing policy, process for budgets that exceed the spending cap, funding strategies to mitigate spending cap exceedance, 2022 debt incurred, debt financing opportunities, and timelines associated with the debt financing report. D. Valentim responded to questions from Committee Members.

5. Opening Public Comments & Questions

Chair Bower invited comments and questions from the public on the proposed 2022 Capital Budget and 2023-2031 Long Range Capital Forecast.

Chris Baker, Ajax resident, asked about the Parkland reserve fund. D. Valentim responded to the question from Mr. Baker.

6. Review of Budget

6.1 2022 Capital Budget and 2023-2031 Long Range Capital Forecast

Chair Bower led the Committee through a section-by-section review of the proposed 2022 Capital Budget and 2023-2031 Long Range Capital Forecast. Questions and discussion focused primarily upon the following projects:

Project List

Studies and Other Initiatives

CCD002: Ajax Arts & Cultural Plan

Committee Members sought clarification on the necessary timing of the study this year, noting that it was not forecasted historically. Committee Members asked questions regarding community culture initiatives, consultant fees, and contributions to economic development. Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, noted that the Ajax Arts & Cultural Plan is outdated and supports recommendations identified in the Recreation & Parks Master Plan and the core services review. Robert Gruber, Manager of Community & Cultural Development and Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

That capital project CCD002: Ajax Arts & Cultural Plan be deferred to 2023 for consideration in future capital budgets.

CARRIED

FES024 Auto-Mutual Aid Agreement Review

Committee Members asked questions regarding project scope and rationale, consultant costs, status of the review process from neighbouring municipalities, benefits of a mutual

aid agreement, necessary timing of the project this year, historical data related to failed calls for mutual aid, and opportunities for a joint venture and cost-sharing with the Town of Whitby and City of Pickering. Dave Lang, Fire Chief, provided an overview of the review, noting that the review supports recommendations outlined in the Fire Master Plan. Committee Members asked staff to provide data related to the number of times the Town has had a failed call for mutual aid and to investigate opportunities for alternative funding prior to the December 13, 2021 Council meeting.

CAO003 Resident Engagement & Satisfaction Survey
CAO004 Customer Service Strategy

Committee members expressed concerns about project costs and timelines. Committee Members asked questions regarding survey platform and opportunities to combine the Resident Engagement and Satisfaction Survey and the Customer Service Strategy. Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, discussed project scope and rationale, and outlined differences between the two projects. S. Baker noted that the Customer Services Strategy is outdated and forms part of the Strategic Plan approved by Council.

CCD005 Ajax 3D Letters Public Art Installation

Committee Members asked questions regarding project costs, installation locations, maintenance costs, and size of the 3D letters. R. Gruber responded to questions from Committee Members.

FES021 Community Risk Assessment
FES023 Fire Station Location Study

Committee Members asked if there is an opportunity to combine the studies. D. Lang provided an overview of the studies, noting differences and legislative requirements.

<u>Technology</u>

ITS004 AVL - Dashcam Solution

Committee Members asked questions regarding project costs, mobile solutions, project timelines, dashcam installation methods, integration compatibility, number of fleet, and opportunities to monitor speeds and productivity. Chris Walker, Manager of Technology and Innovation, and D. Meredith discussed different aspects of the project including technology, liability and risk management, business planning, and workplace safety. D. Valentim noted that the project is being funded from the Town's insurance reserve and supports the Town against insurance claims.

ITS003 Human Resource Mgmt System (HRMS)

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for implementation of the system, project costs, and timelines. C. Walker provided an overview of the system, noting that the centralized system would be leveraged by all Business Departments and that the project was identified as part of the IT Strategic Plan.

Town Buildings

1020111 Cricket Improvements

Committee Members asked questions regarding project funding, total project costs, funds available for basketball infrastructure, and basketball improvement locations. D. Valentim and Kassandra Cruciano, Grants, Partnerships, and Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, responded to questions and reviewed the grant funding approval process.

BMT006 Facility Condition Audits

Committee Members asked if facility condition audits were included in the Asset Management Plan review. Committee Members asked questions regarding timing of the last facility condition audit, rationale for facilities included in the scope of work, and timelines associated with the inclusion of non-core assets in the Asset Management Plan. D. Valentim and D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed requirements and inclusions under the Town's Asset Management Plan, noting that core assets will be considered in Phase 2 of the Asset Management Plan

BMT031 Facility Asbestos Audits

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for the facility asbestos audit, availability of the previous 1990 audit, and facilities included in the 1990 audit. D. Valentim noted that the audit is a requirement of the new asset retirement obligation (ARO), a Public Sector Accounting Standard which the Town is obligated to comply with by 2023. Committee Members asked staff to locate and review the 1990 audit prior to the December 13, 2021 Council meeting.

BMT069 Fire Station 2 Design – Fire Master Plan

Committee Members asked questions regarding timelines associated with project completion and project scope. Committee Members asked if the Envision Durham process should be completed ahead of this project. D. Lang discussed timelines, staffing accommodations for a secondary crew, and existing safety considerations at Station 2. D. Valentim noted that the project is largely funded through development charges and requires Council's approval of the 2022 operating budget in order to move forward.

1019111 ACC - Replace 5 Rooftop Units
1019911 Main Branch Boiler Replacement
1020011 ACC - Lighting Retrofit Ph II

Committee Members asked questions regarding current conditions, urgency of replacements, project costs, and opportunities to align the projects with the facility condition audits. D. Meredith noted that the projects were historically forecasted, design work has been completed, and construction is scheduled for 2022.

BMT001 Roof Repl-Rotary Park, Hartrick and Quaker

Committee Members asked questions regarding status of design work and status of roof repairs at Rotary Park. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That project BMT001: Roof Repl-Rotary Park, Hartrick and Quaker be deferred to 2023 for consideration in future capital budgets.

CARRIED

BMT050 St. Francis Projector Screen Replacement

Committee Members asked questions regarding average annual usage and opportunities to increase future use at St. Francis. D. Valentim noted that the funding source for this project is from the St. Francis Giving Campaign. R. Gruber discussed opportunities to improve customer experience and increase attendance.

BMT071 St. Francis Centre - Stained Glass Window Rehab-Ph II

Committee Members sought clarification on the project's phased approach and asked questions regarding window conditions and the number of windows that need to be restored. D. Meredith discussed the 2019 assessment including deficiencies, life cycle, and replacement costs.

BMT014 ARC Pool Re-Grouting and Lateral Filter Replacement

Committee Members sought clarification on the maintenance requirements and the facility's age, and asked questions regarding costs, warranties and recourse, and life cycles. Chris Vida, Acting Director of Recreation, Culture & Community Development, discussed grout condition and filtration life cycle maintenance.

Parking Lots

ENG019 St. Andrew's Parking Lot (Resurfacing)

Committee Members asked questions regarding parking lot condition, and if this project is part of the Recreation and Parks Master Plan. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

ENG236 Mill St. Comm. Center Parking Lot (Recons)

Committee Members asked if the Mill St. Community Centre will be included in the facility audit. D. Meredith responded to the question from Committee Members.

ENG122 MCC East & South Parking Lot (Recons)

Committee Members sought clarification on when the MCC parking lot was last resurfaced. D. Meredith noted that the north portion of the parking lot was completed in 2018.

Parks & Open Spaces

ENG069 North Ajax - Cricket Infrastructure

Committee Members asked questions regarding proposed locations. D. Meredith responded to the question from Committee Members.

ENG071 St. Andrew's Park - Playground and Amenities

Committee Members sought clarification on why the project has been accelerated from the 2024 capital budget to the 2022 capital budget, and asked questions regarding existing park conditions, rationale for park development prior to growth in the area, status of existing playgrounds, funding sources, and neighborhood demographics. D. Meredith and D. Valentim responded to questions from Committee Members.

ENG275 St. Andrew's Outdoor Recreational Improvements

Committee Members asked questions regarding opportunities and costs to implement indoor recreational facilities. D. Meredith noted that there is a need for indoor recreational facilities as well as outdoor recreational courts.

ENG284 Forest Ridge Trail - Forest Ridge Park to Eagle Ridge School

Committee Members sought clarification on why this project is included in the 2022 capital budget. Committee Members discussed trail conditions, potential for a cost sharing initiative, and maintenance requirements. D. Meredith noted that this trail is a cost sharing initiative with the Durham District School Board. Andrew Jackson, Supervisor of Infrastructure, Construction and Design, noted that the school board is attempting to secure funding.

ENG011 Playground Replacement - Betty Bujold Park

Committee Members asked about the cost increase to the project A. Jackson discussed the rationale for the cost increase, noting that the retrofit of the trail is included in the cost.

ENG338 Cedar Park Batting Cages Replacement

Committee Members sought clarification regarding historical allocation of project funds and rationale for why there is an open capital account. D. Meredith discussed the rationale for batting cage replacements and opportunities to repurpose existing batting cages. A. Jackson discussed costs associated with the replacement and relocation of Cedar Park infrastructure. Committee Members asked staff to report back regarding historical funding allocated to this project in December of 2019.

ENV003 ARC - Infield Rehab on Diamonds 5 and 6

Committee Members asked if the Town is responsible for ongoing rehabilitation costs. D. Meredith responded to the question.

ENG044 Millers Creek Softball Fencing Replacement'

Committee Members sought clarification on the necessary timing of the project this year.

D. Meredith advised that the fence should be replaced to mitigate liability and risk.

Committee recessed at 9:57 p.m.

Committee resumed at 10:04 p.m.

Vehicles & Equipment

FLT078 Street Sweeper
FLT079 Verticutter (Additional)
FLT080 5 Ton Truck w/Brine Plow

Committee Members asked staff to provide justifications for expanding fleet inventory. D. Meredith discussed service levels and enhanced service delivery in response to growth.

FLT194 By-Law - Pickup Truck (Additional)
FLT196 By-Law - Pickup Truck (Additional)

Committee Members asked questions regarding service vehicles currently utilized by By-law Services, justifications for additional fleet, waterfront management revenue, and offsets for the purchase. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, discussed challenges with hybrid vehicles for By-law Services usage, out of service vehicles, and increased staffing and service levels resulting in additional transportation needs.

FLT086 Pumper Apparatus Unit #P45 (2006)
1023211 Repl FES Pumper P49 2021

Committee Members asked questions regarding alternative funding sources, impacts if the project is deferred, legislative requirements, fleet life cycle, opportunities to debenture the purchase, and strategies to grow the Town's reserves. D. Lang, D. Valentim, and S. Baker discussed parameters of the current debt policy, opportunities to amend the debt policy, impacts to future budgets if the project is deferred, timelines associated with building trucks, payment requirements, incentives for advanced payment, internal borrowing, and requirements under the Fire Underwriters Survey.

ENG084 Parks Two Stream Waste/Recycling Containers

Committee Members sought clarification on the scope of the project and costs. D. Meredith provided an overview of the project, noting that the Town is positioning infrastructure with the intention that the Region of Durham will administer municipal waste collection in the park systems.

FAC005 Repl. ARC Floor Machines

Committee Members asked questions regarding inventory and condition of the floor machines. C. Vida noted that the floor machines have exceeded their life cycle and require replacement in order to maintain service levels.

FAC014 Repl. Fitness Centre Equip 2022

Committee Members asked questions regarding allocation of the equipment and the last time the equipment was replaced. C. Vida discussed asset management life cycling, condition of existing equipment, and noted a reduction in funding requirements for this project.

FLT007 By-Law Hybrid Car/SUV Unit #15001 (2015)

Committee Members asked questions regarding justifications for replacement of this vehicle given a new truck is coming online. D. Meredith discussed the rationale for the replacement and noted that the new truck will support expanded service.

FLT013 Single Axle Snow Plow Unit #24003 (2008)

Committee Members asked questions regarding usage and high maintenance costs. D. Meredith discussed vehicle usage and advised that he could provide a detailed maintenance report.

FLT017 Pickup Truck Unit #12513 (2013)
FLT018 Pickup Truck Unit #12514 (2013)

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for replacement of vehicles with low kilometers and low maintenance costs. D. Meredith discussed vehicle assessments and condition rating. S. Baker noted that surplus vehicles go to auction at an optimal time in order to capitalize on value. Mayor Collier requested a copy of the maintenance report prior to the December 13, 2021 Council meeting.

FLT019 Stake Truck Unit #13006 (2012)
FLT022 Stake Truck Unit #13007 (2012)
FLT040 Building Hybrid Car Unit #15301 (2015)
FLT041 Building Hybrid Car Unit #15302 (2015)
FLT042 Building Sedan Unit #10013 (2015)

Committee Members inquired why vehicles with low kilometers and low maintenance costs are being replaced D. Meredith advised that he would provide maintenance reports prior to the December 13, 2021 Council meeting.

<u>Road Network</u>

FES035 Fire Station 1 - Traffic Management Improvements

Committee Members asked for clarification on the scope of the project. Aaron Burridge, Deputy Fire Chief, provided an overview of the project and discussed options to mitigate traffic issues. D. Lang discussed traffic flow issues.

ENG045 Rossland Rd Widening-Westney to Salem
ENG246 Rossland Widening-Salem to Lake Ridge

Committee Members asked questions regarding allocation of funds, timelines associated with detailed design, sidewalk infrastructure, multi-use trails and environmental assessment, and opportunities to allocate street lighting responsibilities to the Region. D.

Valentim and Ranil Fernando, Manager of Infrastructure & Asset Management, responded to questions from Committee Members. D. Meredith noted that the Town and the Region are working on developing a road transfer framework for Westney Road and Rossland Road.

ETP050 Hunt Street Extension - EA Addendum

Committee Members sought clarification on the scope of the project. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, provided an overview of the project.

ENG057 MUT Ravenscroft - Beverton/Paulynn Park

Committee Members asked if this is a new trail or a replacement trail, and condition of existing trails. D. Meredith and Rick Chalmers, Supervisor of Infrastructure and Asset Management, discussed asset conditions of the Town's trail system.

ENG249 Kingston Rd MUT - Salem to Lake Ridge

Committee Members asked questions regarding necessary timing of the project this year, project scope, multi-use trail funding expectations, and maintenance and upgrade costs. D. Meredith noted that this project is related to the Durham-Scarborough Bus Rapid Transit Metrolinx project. D. Meredith and R. Fernando discussed project timing, design elements, funding requirements, construction segments, and infrastructure costs. D. Valentim noted that the project is funded through development charges. Committee Members asked staff to report back on alternative funding strategies and requirements of Metrolinx to pay development charges.

ENG144 Audley Road Resurfacing

Committee Members sought clarification regarding the segment of Audley Road scheduled for resurfacing and asked if there are plans to resurface Church Street. R. Chalmers and D. Meredith responded to the question from Committee Members.

ENG283 Church Cold In Place-Hydro Corr to Taunton

Committee Members asked questions regarding project rationale and timing, project scope, and project funding. R. Fernando and D. Meredith discussed project justifications, project scope, and funding sources.

ETP016 Lake Driveway Improvements Design

Committee Members expressed concerns regarding the timing of the project, pedestrian safety, and access, and discussed scheduled improvements including crosswalk infrastructure, signage, and a traffic calming study.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That capital project ETP016: Lake Driveway Improvements - Design be deferred to 2023 for consideration in future capital budgets.

CARRIED

ENG021 Traffic Signal Pedestrian Countdowns Repl.

Committee Members asked if the accessible pedestrian signals are a legislative requirement. D. Meredith responded to the question from Committee Members.

ENG049 Shoal Point Rd M&O-Range Line to Ashbury

Committee Members sought clarification on the scope of the project. R. Fernando responded to the question from Committee Members.

ENG007 Accessible Ped Signal - Harwood & Biggs
ENG130 Access Ped Sig-Harwood & Notre Dame CSS
ENG146 Accessible Ped Sig-Westney RR31/O'Brien
ENG181 Access. Ped Sig-Pickering Beach/Emperor
ENG133 Accessible Ped Sigl-Harwood & Chapman
ENG134 Accessible Ped Sig-Harwood & Ringer
ENG131 Acc. Ped Sig-Harwood&Mandrake/Gardiner
ENG132 Accessible Ped Sig-Harwood & Doric/Ontario
ENG211 Accessible Ped Signal-Harwood & Kerrison
ENG212 Accessible Ped Signal-Church & Delaney

Committee Members sought clarification on the necessary timing of the projects this year. Committee Members asked if traffic signal UPS backup systems are a legislative requirement and if other municipalities are implementing this system. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members and agreed to report back to Committee regarding implementation of UPS backup systems among area municipalities prior to the December 13, 2021 Council meeting.

Bridges & Culverts

ENG088 Bridge 112 - Lakefront Footbridge (Repairs)

Committee Members asked if the scope of the project has been expanded and rationale for increased project costs. Staff agreed to provide details prior to the December 13, 2021 Council meeting.

Storm Water Network

ETP009 Waterfront Environmental Assessment

Committee Members asked questions about the timeline for the study and costs associated with the study, rationale for why the Town is paying for a study on TRCA property, cost-sharing opportunities, consideration of the shoreline gap analysis in the environmental assessment, and shelf life of a municipal class environmental assessment. G. Romanowski and S. Ruddy responded to questions from Committee members and provided rationale for timing of the study.

ETP033 Stormwater Funding Implementation Strategy

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for consultant fees, timelines associated with implementation of the strategy, and funding sources. G. Romanowski and S. Ruddy responded to questions from Committee Members.

ETP040 Stormwater Network Inspection 2022

Committee Members asked if a stormwater network inspection was completed. S. Ruddy responded to the question from Committee Members.

Summary of New Capital Projects by Driver

Committee Members had no comments or questions on this section of the capital budget document.

Financing Summary

Committee Members had no comments or questions on this section of the capital budget document.

Continuity Schedules

Committee Members discussed the status of the Town's reserves relative to the capital budget and future capital needs.

7. Closing Public Comments & Questions

Chair Bower invited any final comments and questions from members of the public.

Chris Baker, Ajax resident, asked about value of proceeds from sale of used and surplus vehicles and equipment, street sweeping services, and opportunities to contract for the provision of fleet vehicles instead of purchasing additional fleet. D. Valentim and D. Meredith responded to questions from Mr. Baker. S. Baker noted that the Operations & Environmental Services Department is currently undergoing a core services review that will look at the balance of contracted versus in-house services that the Town provides.

8. FIN-2021-17: 2022 Capital Budget; 2023-2031 Long Range Capital Forecast

Main Motion

1. That the following 2022 General Levy Funded Reserve Allocations be approved:

Reserve	
Building Maintenance	844,400
Election	73,000
Post Build Out	108,300
Development	200,000
Strategic Initiatives	387,000

Roads Maintenance	1,703,200
General Infrastructure Maintenance	946,900
Vehicle and Equipment	1,657,900
Total Allocations	**5,920,700**

2. That the 2022 Capital Budget in the amount of $29,410,600 be approved;

3. That the 2023 – 2031 Long Range Capital Forecast be received for information.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: S. Collier

That the 2022 Capital Budget and 2023-2031 Long Range Capital Forecast recommendations, as amended, be referred to the December 13, 2021 Council meeting for consideration, and that staff be directed to provide further information to Council with respect to Member's questions on the capital projects discussed at the November 29th, 2021 budget meeting.

CARRIED

Members of Committee and Budget Chair Bower thanked staff for their hard work on presenting the 2022 Capital Budget.

9. Adjournment (12:18 a.m.)

Moved by: S. Lee

That the November 29, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee Capital Budget Meeting be adjourned.

CARRIED